How long does it take to form soil?

The time needed to form a soil depends on the Climate. The environments which is characterized by mild climate, takes 200-400 years to form one cm of soil and in wet tropical area, soil formation is faster and takes upto 200 years. To become a well matured soil, it takes about 3000 years.

Uses of soils

Soil is one of the important natural resource. It is a basic requirement for plant growth and supports various life forms on the earth.

- The minerals present in the soil enhance and nourishes the crops and plants.
- It is used in making of ceramics or pottery.
- It is a source of material for construction and handicraft works.
- It acts as natural filter of water and purifies it.
- Soil supports ecosystem and play an important role in land management.

Rocks and soils are the important renewable natural resources. Both of them play an important role in everyday life of human beings as well as economic development. Nowadays rock-based companies are in increase which provide employment to a sizeable population. Soils attract human settlement and other economic activities. As India is an agricultural country, the proper management of soil resource will lead to sustainable food production besides its use for various other purposes. So, the soil resources must be conserved.

Recap

- A rock is an aggregate of one or more minerals.
- The word **'Sedimentary'** has been derived from Latin word **'Sedimentum'** means settling down.
- Igneous rocks are the primary rocks formed first on the earth.
- Soil is a mixture of organic matter, minerals, gases, liquids and organisms that together support life.

GLOSSARY		
Crust	Outermost layer of the earth	புவியின்மேலோடு
Lava	Hot molten rock erupted from a volcano.	லாவா
Magma	Hot fluid or semi-fluid material found beneath the earth crust.	பாறைக் குழம்பு
Rock cycle	The continuous process of transformations of rocks from one form to another.	பாறை சுழற்சி

Evaluation

I Choose the correct answer

1. Which of the following is known as sphere of rocks
   a) Atmosphere b) Biosphere
   c) Lithosphere d) Hydrosphere

2. World soil day is observed on
   a) 15th August
   b) 12th January
   c) 15th October
   d) 5th December

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